Los Angeles Homelessness Count

How does homelessness affect us?

GROUP 20

POD CAPTAIN:
NANCY



Naomi Garcia



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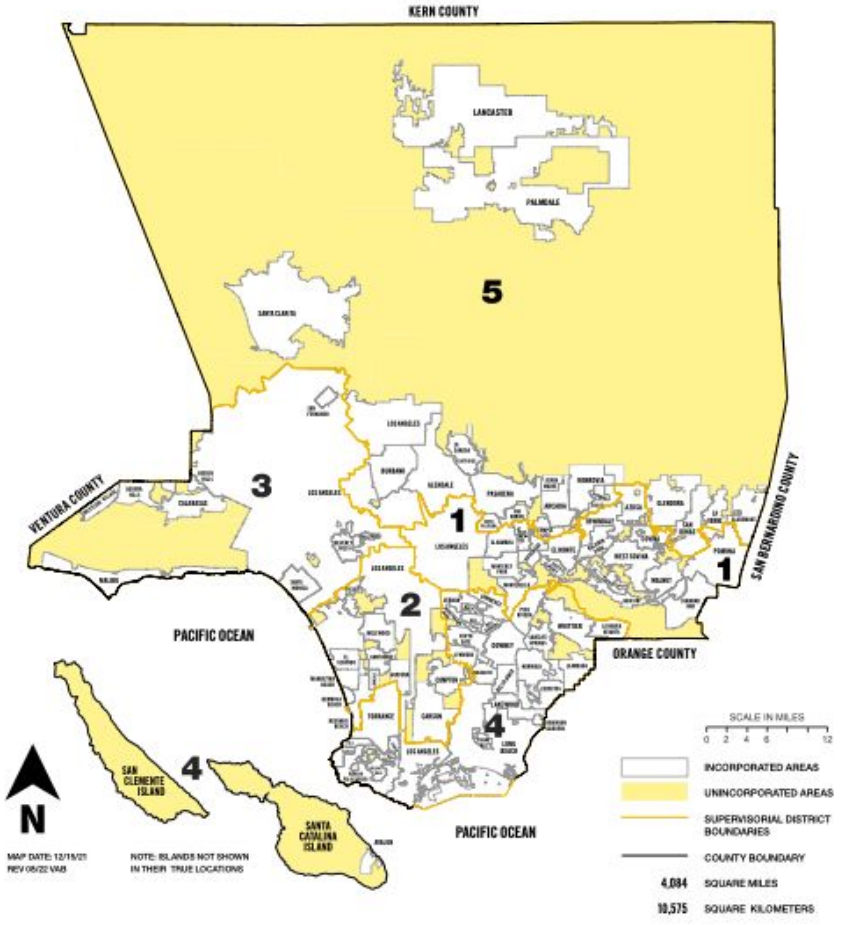
Daisy Garcia



Jason Suh

Objective

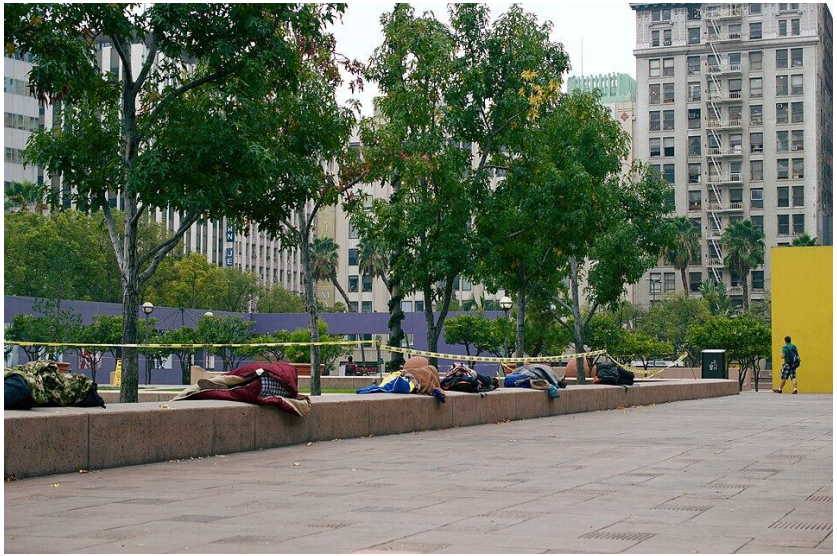
- Examine the significance of homelessness and the distribution of sheltered and unsheltered populations across Los Angeles County through data analysis of trends, patterns, and disparities across jurisdictions, while providing recommendations to address gaps in shelter assistance and high levels of homelessness.



LA County Map

Motivating Questions

- Which type of cities (unincorporated vs incorporated) have more resources to provide enough shelter for their homeless population?
- What cities need the most help in terms of unsheltered populations?
- Where do the most critical infrastructure gaps lie?



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Context

Effects of Homelessness

$20B

California has spent over $20 billion on homelessness over 5 years between 2019-2024; still homelessness grew 6% in 2023 from the year prior.[1]

70%

70% of the lowest-wage American households spend more than half their income on rent, placing them at high risk of homelessness.[2]

[1] *California spent billions on homelessness without tracking if it worked.* (2024).
[2] Homelessness Data & Trends (n.d.)

Problem

- LA residents face issues such as:
  - Using more of their income on housing.
  - Living in more overcrowded conditions.
  - Having the highest rates of unsheltered homelessness of any city in the country.[1]



"Historical Housing and Land Use Study", p. 1

[1] "Historical Housing and Land Use Study", p. 7 (2024)

Methodology & Definitions

Methodology

We used the LAHSA's 2020 census tract data for the LA Continuum of Care. The data can be broken down into three main governance areas:

Incorporated Cities, Unincorporated Areas, and LA City Neighborhoods.

Through this, we compared sheltered and unsheltered population counts across tracts, while recognizing that these data rely on standardized field estimates and multiplier formulas.

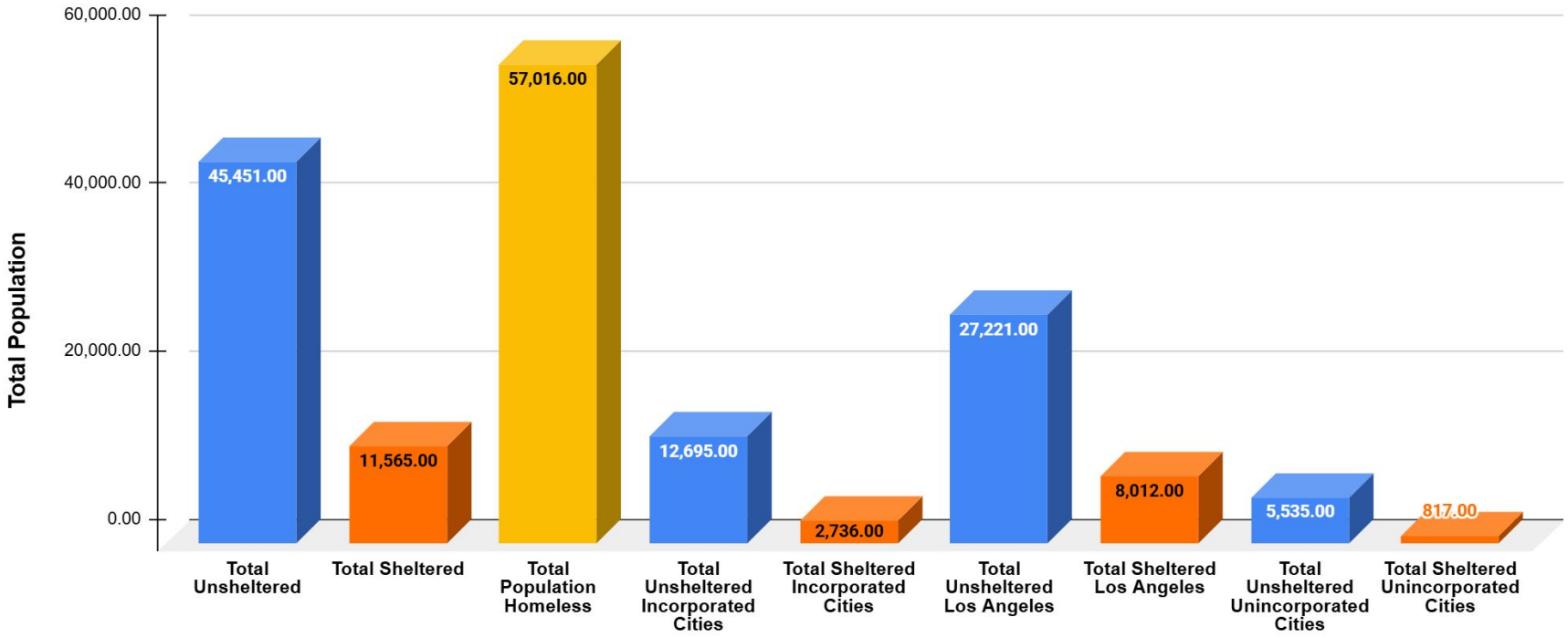
The data herein is for informational purposes, and may not have been prepared for or be suitable for legal, engineering, or surveying intents.

Key Framework Definitions

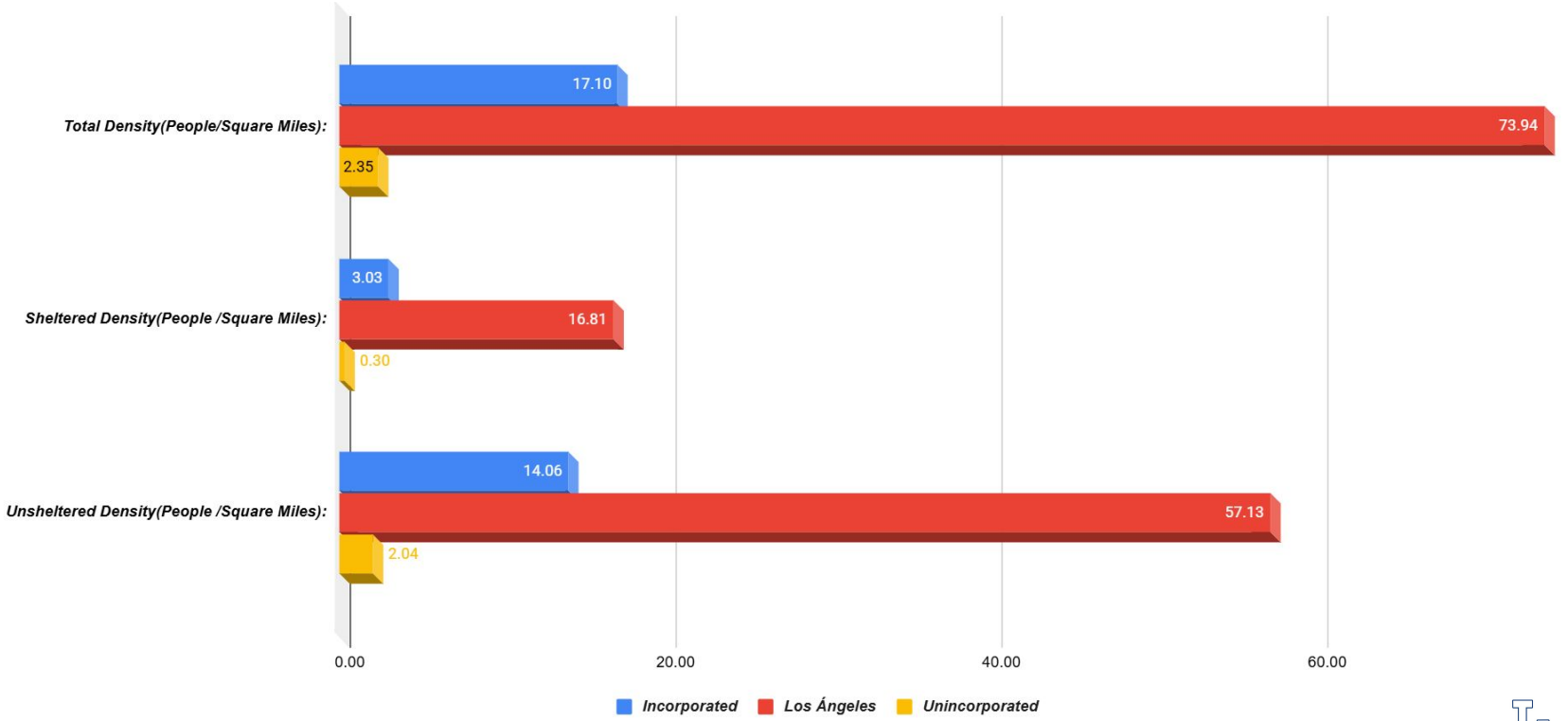
- **Los Angeles Continuum of Care (LA CoC):** The regional planning body, coordinating housing and services for homeless individuals across most of LA County (excluding independent CoCs like Long Beach, Pasadena, and Glendale).
- **Jurisdiction**: The official administrative authority or governance boundary responsible for local land use, zoning, and resource allocation.
- **Incorporated Cities:** Municipalities with their own local governments and elected city councils.
- **Unincorporated Areas:** Communities or geographic areas outside incorporated city boundaries, governed directly by the Los Angeles County Board of Supervisors.
- **LA City Neighborhoods:** Distinct communities located within the municipal boundaries of the City of Los Angeles.

Findings

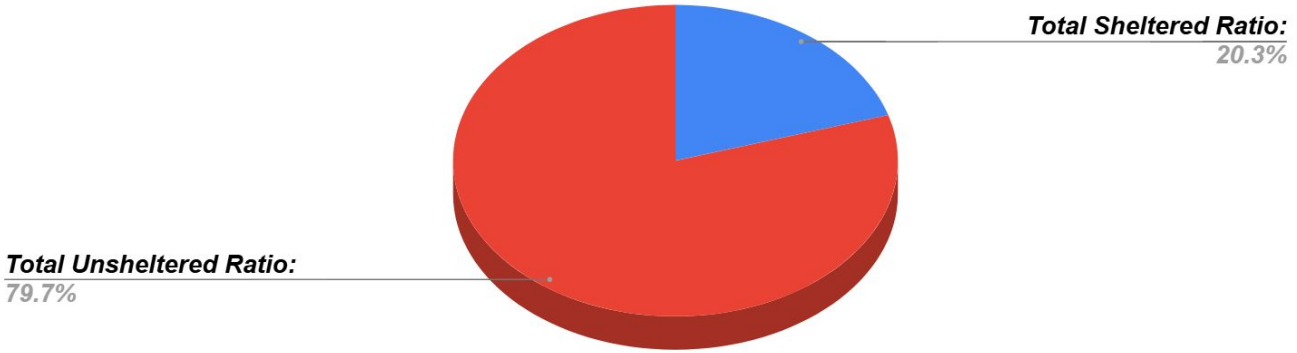
Sheltered vs. Unsheltered Homelessness in Los Angeles County



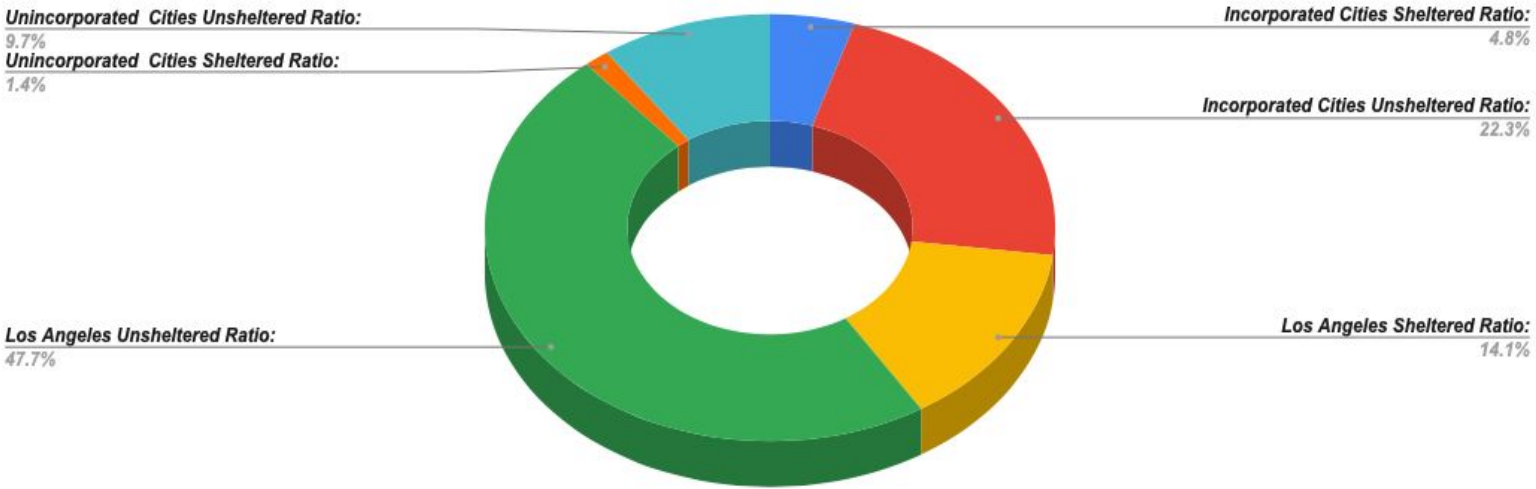
Homeless Density Across Los Angeles County by Jurisdictions



Homelessness Ratio Across Los Angeles County: Sheltered & Unsheltered



Homelessness Ratio Across Los Angeles County by Jurisdiction



High-Need Zones: Top 15 Areas by Sheltered vs. Unsheltered Totals

CSA Label	Total Sheltered Pop	Total Unsheltered Pop
Los Angeles - Wholesale District	2,287	2,598
City of Long Beach	452	1,582
City of Lancaster	31	1,949
Los Angeles - Venice	16	1,660
Los Angeles - North Hollywood	249	1,042
Los Angeles - Downtown	361	868
Los Angeles - Hollywood	319	883
Unincorporated - Florence-Firestone	0	997
Los Angeles - Sun Valley	476	426
Los Angeles - Vermont Knolls	751	148
City of Santa Monica	169	642
Los Angeles - Westlake	230	565
Los Angeles - Vermont Vista	219	523
City of Compton	2	720
Los Angeles - Boyle Heights	111	609

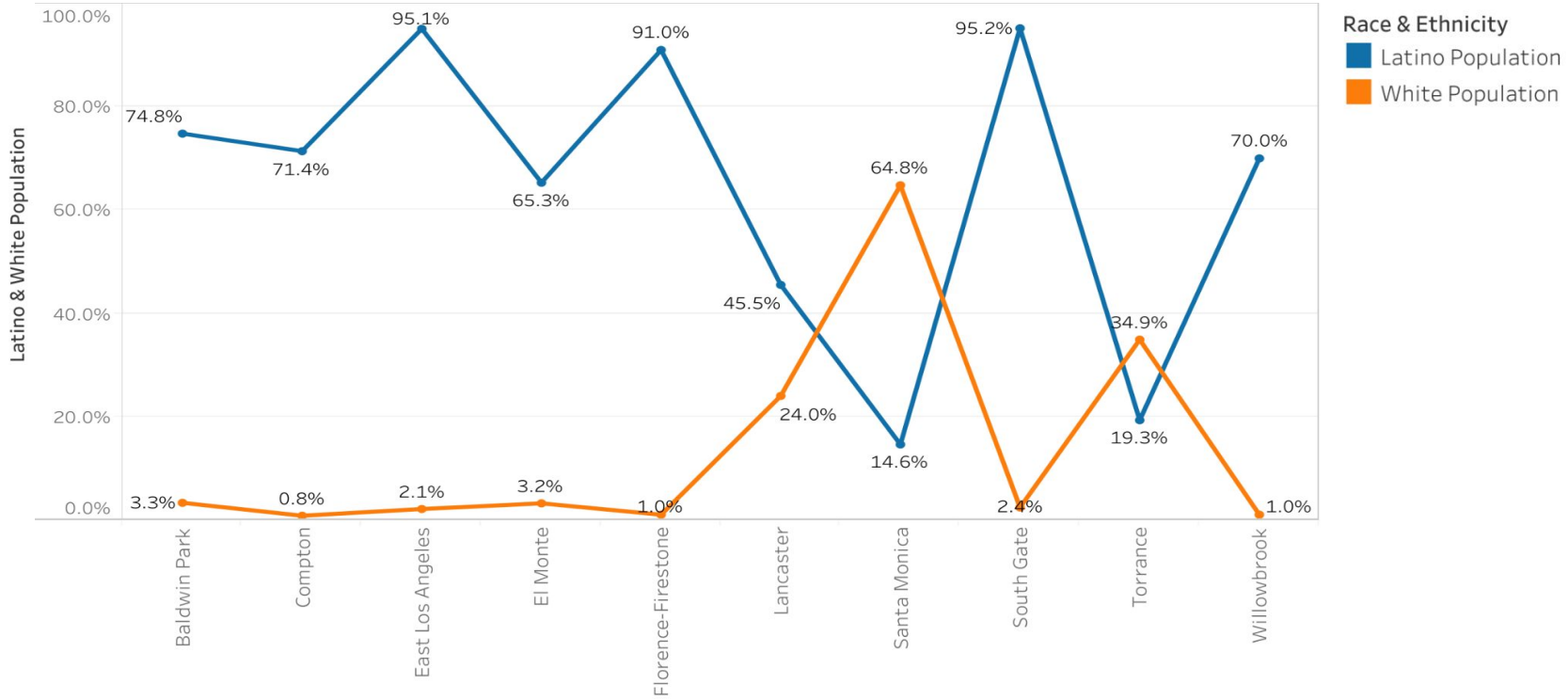


Shelter Infrastructure Gaps Across the Top 15 Areas

The data reveals extreme polarization: many high-need areas have almost no sheltered capacity.

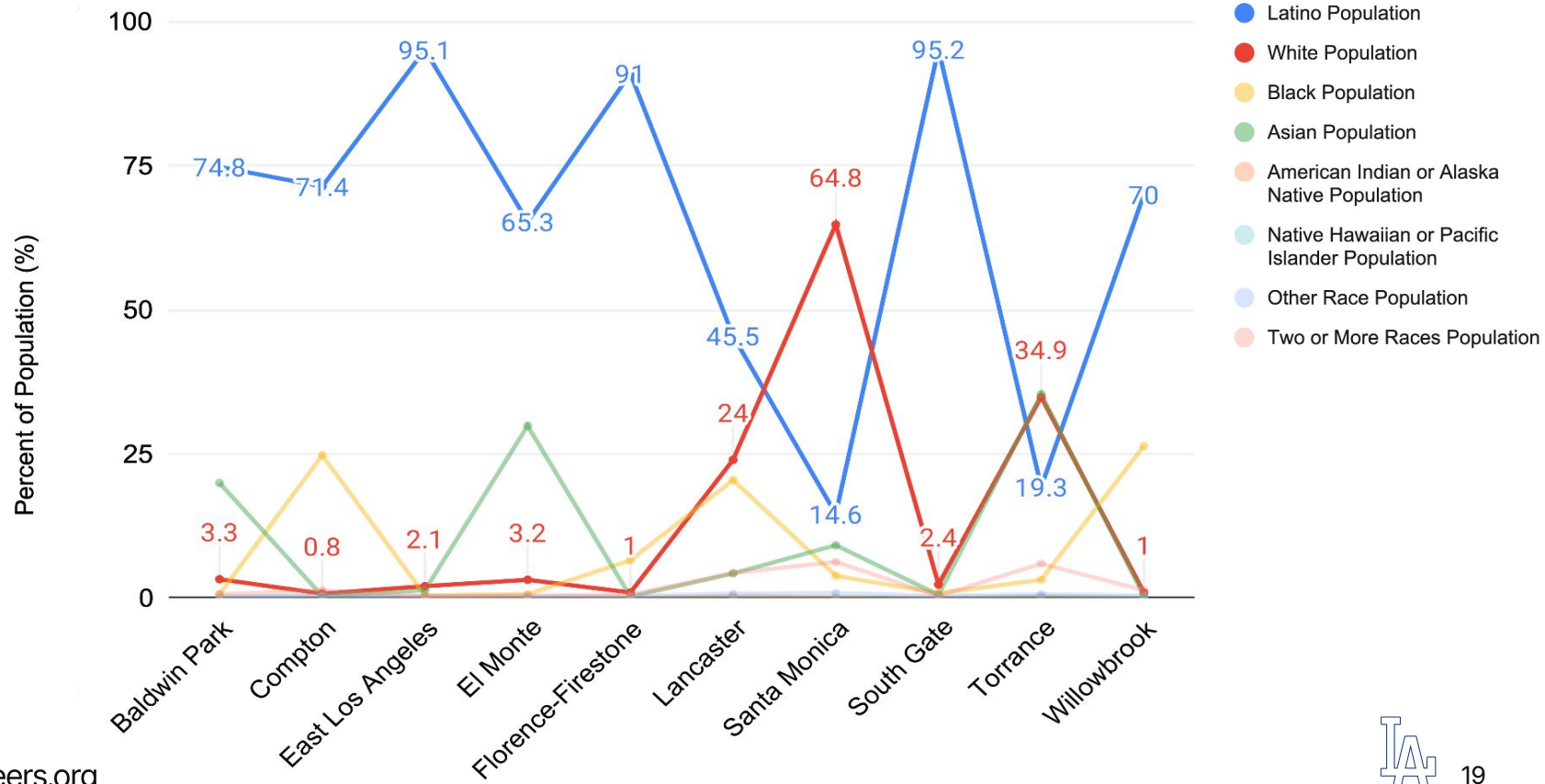
While areas like the Los Angeles Wholesale District maintain a high unsheltered count alongside a comparable sheltered capacity, jurisdictions like Florence-Firestone and Compton face hundreds of unsheltered individuals with near-zero shelter infrastructure.

The Most Populous Cities of Unsheltered Homelessness are not a majority White Population*

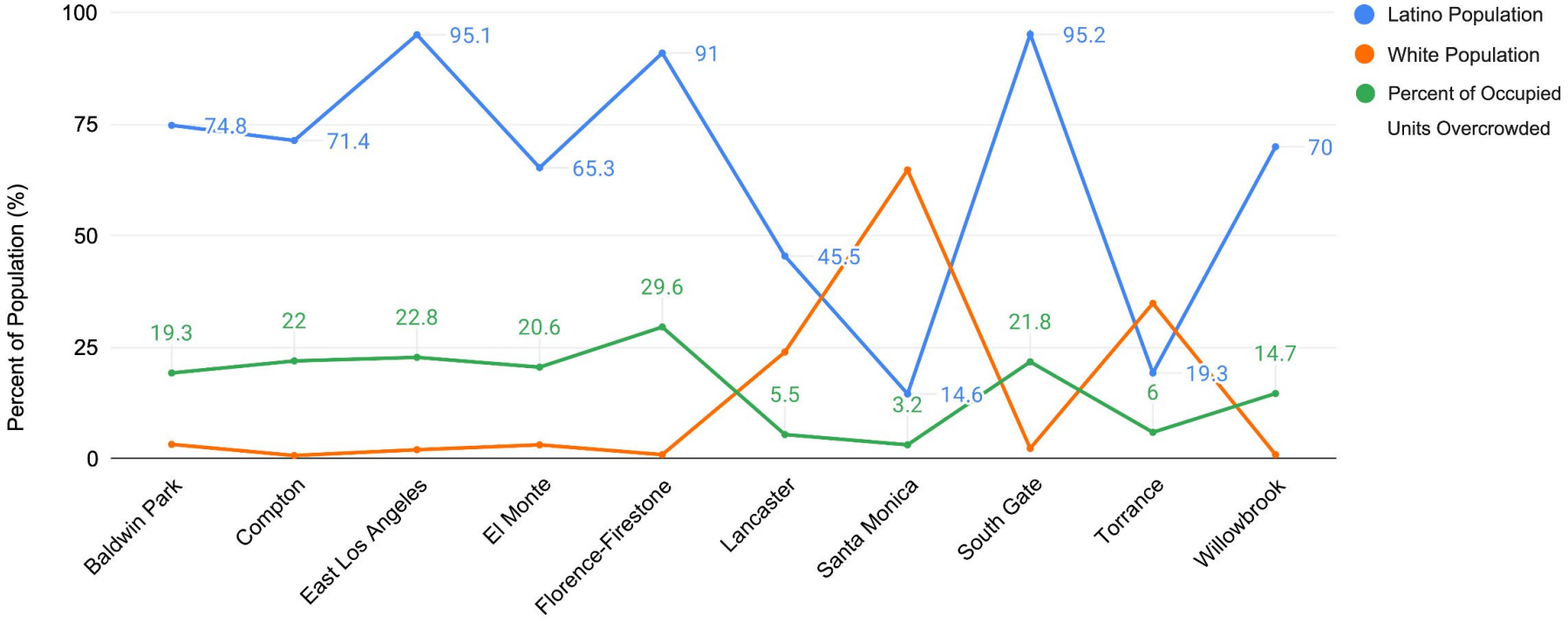


*2024 data excluding City of LA and unreported cities (i.e. Long Beach)

The Most Populous Cities of Unsheltered Homelessness are not a majority White Population*



The Distribution of Occupied Units Overcrowded are correlated with the majority Latino Population



Identifying Highest Unsheltered Pop Ratios

East Los Angeles (POC)

- East Los Angeles 95.1%, South Gate 95.2%
- Has a higher urban concentration

Lancaster

- Encampments and unsheltered individuals are concentrated in denser residential and commercial

Least Unsheltered Pop (POC)

- Santa Monica 14.6%
- Torrance 19.3%

Why East LA is Highly Concentrated & Densely Unhoused

1. Rent Burden & Housing Overcrowding

2. Urban Density & Industrial/ Commercial Zoning

3. Regional Shelter Capacity

Parallel City Case Studies (Lancaster/Oakland)

Vehicle Residency

Oakland

- Implemented Safe RV Parking Sites with non profits
- Sites include 24hr security, water, electricity, mobile showers, laundry facilities
- Protecting residents from ticketing, impoundment and property theft

Rental/Parking Program Under California Mobile Home Park Laws

- Rent ($250/month or one third of income) for a secure space

Short Term Solutions: Reorganizing Aid

1. Off Street Safe RV Parking & Sanitation Hubs

   ACTION: Designate safe parking locations ; Equipped with 24hr security amenities and case management

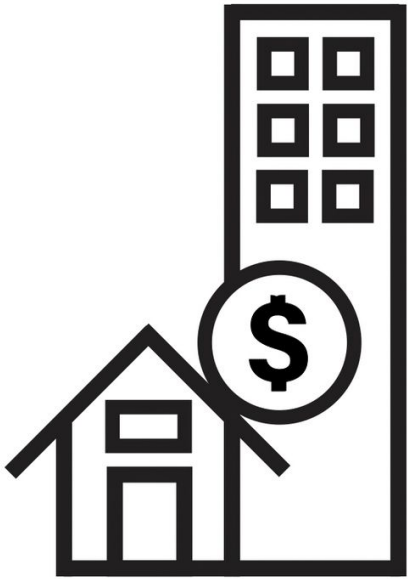
2. Precision Placement of Mobile Aid (Sanitation, Healthcare, Outreach)

   ACTION: Using Density Unsheltered metrics to deploy mobile health clinics, sanitation/ hygiene units, and street medicine directly to density hot spots

Conclusion

Key Findings

- About four unsheltered people for every one sheltered person.
- The City of Los Angeles holds the highest density of homelessness in the county.
- Demographics of cities were highly associated with unsheltered homelessness populations.
    - Only 2 of the 10 most populous unsheltered homelessness locations have a higher White population than Latino population



Isisrf/Wikimedia Commons - Edited dollar sign

Recommendations

- Increase funding for shelter crisis (i.e. nonprofit and local agencies) providing more resources for social reintegration, housing assistance and job readiness programs.
- Target allocation to "resource deserts" by prioritizing funding, implementing temporary infrastructure, where there is a high unsheltered-to-sheltered ratio.
- Accommodating affordable housing for communities of color and those at risk.
    - ~40% of women experiencing homelessness had suffered sexual violence at some point in their lives.[1]
    - 41.6 million refugees globally; 68.7 million people displaced within own country due to conflict / violence.[2]



05 Levi Clancy/Wikimedia Commons

1. Sexual violence against women experiencing homelessness: Systematic review and meta-analysis. (2026).
2. United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees, 2025

Thank you!

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Written Report

Los Angeles County Homelessness Written Report FA26 C700 G20